

Direct object pronouns

CHAPITRE 2

In English Direct object pronouns refer to someone or something that receives the action of the verb. They replace direct object nouns to avoid repetition. Direct object pronouns are placed after the verb.

English object pronouns that replace things are **it** and **them**. Object pronouns that can refer to people are **him, her, you, me, us**, and **them**.

I saw that film and I enjoyed **it** immensely.

Mom took Peter to school. She picked **him** up later.

They were not using their mountain bikes so they sold **them**.

A Circle the direct object pronoun and underline the noun it refers to.

1. Finish your homework now and hand **it** in tomorrow
2. I bought an apple for later, but I ate **it** immediately.
3. If you don't know Russell, let me introduce **him** to you!
4. I heard a lot about your brothers, but I never met **them**.
5. I wanted to see two movies, but my friend had already seen **them**.
6. Did you phone Grandmother or did you email **her**?
7. Do you like these flowers? I bought **them** for my mom.
8. I sent you my first novel. You never read **it**, did you?

In French Direct object pronouns can also be used to avoid repeating direct object nouns that have already been mentioned.

—Tu aimes le sirop de menthe?

—Pas du tout. Je **le** déteste.

The direct object pronouns are as follows:

me (*me*)

nous (*us*)

te (*you*)

vous (*you*)

le/la (*him/her, it*)

les (*them*)

In the present tense, direct object pronouns go before the conjugated verb. If there is an infinitive, they go before the infinitive. Note that before a verb beginning with a vowel sound, **me, te, le, and la** change to **m', t', and l'**.

Je **vous** invite tous chez moi.

Le film est bon et ils veulent **le** regarder.

Ma grand-mère **m'**aime beaucoup.

Je **l'**ai cherché, mais je ne **l'**ai pas trouvé.

DIRECT OBJECT PRONOUNS

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B Circle the direct object pronoun and underline the noun it refers to.

1. Elle essaye les robes et les achète.
2. La jupe est horrible. Elle ne la prend pas.
3. Est-ce que vous montez les lits ou les descendez?
4. Marcel, je te souhaite bon anniversaire!
5. Monsieur et Madame Langlois, je vous invite chez moi.
6. J'adore les feux d'artifice et je vais les voir cette année.
7. Cette carte est belle. Tu veux l'envoyer?

C Write answers to the following questions. Use an appropriate pronoun to avoid repeating the underlined words in each answer.

1. Tu aimes les tartes aux pommes?

Non, je ne les aime pas. _____

2. Tu prends le bus pour aller à l'école?

Oui, je le prends pour aller à l'école.

3. Est-ce que tu invites tes professeurs à tes fêtes?

Non, je ne les invite pas à mes fêtes.

4. Achètes-tu souvent ces magazines?

Oui, je les achète souvent.

5. Tu attends ta copine?

Oui, je l'attends.

6. Qui fait la vaisselle chez toi?

Ma mère la fait.

D Compare the following sentences. In your own words, explain the placement of **ne... pas** in sentences that contain direct object pronouns.

Quand il y a juste un verbe conjugué, ne va avant le pronom et pas va après le verbe. Quand il y a un infinitif, ne... pas entoure le verbe conjugué et le pronom va juste avant l'infinitif.

Je **ne** le prends **pas**. Je **ne** vais **pas** le prendre.